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Ocala National Forest - Prospectus for Campground and Related Granger-Thye Concessions

Questions and Answers

Posted (5/9/2025)

Version 2 (5/6/2025)

Questions:

3. Would the FS contact the concessionaire for release of the annual electricity cost information for both the Recreation Area and the Marina?

A: Per the prospectus, *Section I., F. Utilities and Waste Management*, "Applicants should contact current service providers to obtain *estimated* costs for the utilities."

The average estimated utility costs for the Salt Springs Recreation Area are:

Electricity: \$63,000.00

Water and Sewage: \$20,000.00

Waste Disposal: 50,000.00

4. When is the peak season for the Salt Springs recreation area day use?

A: Peak season can be expected during the summer months.

5. How many acres of mowing is expected in the day use and campground?

A: Approximately 35 acres. There are forested areas of the recreation area that do not require mowing.

6. How bad are the wild boars in the campground or recreation area?

A: Wild boars historically have not been an issue at the campground or recreation area. The usual vehicle traffic along Highway 19 usually deters them from the area. For more information on management of wild hog, should they be detected in the recreation area, refer to *Section II., O. Other Pertinent Information, Wildlife Mitigation, Wild Hog*.

7. Are there any routine closures throughout the year (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area)?

A: There are no closures that are routinely scheduled. Should the need to for a closure arise, please refer to *Section II., D. Site Closure*.



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8. When was the last closure and what was it for (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area)?
A: The last two closures were hurricane related, as the impacts of Hurricane Debby, Hurricane Helene and Hurricane Milton were felt by this area. The hazard trees and cleanup from the storm damage went swiftly. The campground was able to reopen fairly soon, but the day use had to remain closed due to the flooding of the St. Johns River, which the Salt Springs Run and Salt Springs Creek feeds into.
9. There was a noticeable revenue lost last year (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area). What was the reason?
A: Please see *Section I., A. Introduction* for the reported gross revenue for the past three years.
The three major hurricanes that impacted Florida (Debby, Helene and Milton), caused significant flooding of the St. Johns River. The water levels were too high to be safe for visitors, and the water clarity posed a risk for alligator awareness.
10. What were the three largest GT Projects in the last year (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area)?
A: Please see *Section II., C. Granger-Thye Fee Offset Agreement* for more information on Granger-Thye (GT) agreements.
The permit for the area was anticipated to end in 2024, though now extended through 2025, it was strategically agreed between the Forest Service and the current concessionaire to not take on major projects that may not be complete due to potential unforeseen delays throughout the year. The three largest projects within the last two years were the tripod fencing, road material for the primitive camping area, and work done for the roads in the primitive camping area.
11. What can be sold in the concession or store (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area)?
A: Anything can be sold, however there are some prohibited items, such as alcohol, fireworks, or weapons. If you sell prepared food (not pre-packaged), please ensure you have any required permits from the county. The Forest Service only strictly prohibits the sale of alcohol and fireworks.
12. What are the small buoys in the water?
A: Those buoys are actually crab traps. The Florida Fish and Wildlife Conservation Commission (the state fish and game division) has jurisdiction over the fishing and trapping in the waterways. Those traps are under permit from them, and are outside of the permit area.
13. The roads were said to be a large previous GT project (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area). Why are there still issues?



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A: With the three hurricanes in 2024, two causing major impacts to the local area, flooding and rainfall caused drainage and runoff issues, particularly to the primitive camping area.

14. Who is responsible for the water systems and well (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area)?

A: The water well is currently maintained by Marion County. The water system (waterlines) in the recreation area (campground and day use) is maintained by the concessionaire. Per the prospectus, *Section I., F. Utilities and Waste Management, Water*, "The permit holder is required to operate and maintain the water system for the campground and day use area in compliance with applicable federal, state, and local laws and regulations for the operation and maintenance of a public drinking water system."

15. Does (Marion) county pay for the cost to maintain the water system?

A: Currently, Marion County pays for the cost to maintain the wells. However, the water system (waterlines) that lead into and are in the recreation area and campground are up to the permit holder to maintain.

16. Who tests the water system (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area)?

A: Currently, Marion County routinely tests the water well. The concessionaire will be responsible for testing their water system.

17. Who manages the camping (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area)? The concessionaire or the Forest Service?

A: Per the prospectus, the concessionaire manages the camping, including the RV sites, primitive camping areas. Reservations are managed by the concessionaire through recreation.gov (*Section II., A. "Recreation.gov"*).

18. Are there any host sites available (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area)? How many?

A: Listed in the prospectus *Section I., C. Description of Developed Recreation Sites and Facilities*, there are currently two available campground host sites, one in the RV campground, and one in the primitive campground. Both sites have full hookups.

19. How many full hookup sites are there (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area)?

A: Listed in the prospectus *Section I., C. Description of Developed Recreation Sites and Facilities*, there are 120 full hookup RV sites available to campers.

20. Who is responsible for the lift station maintenance (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area)?

A: Per the prospectus, *Section I., F. Utilities and Waste Management, Liquid/Solid Waste Disposal*, the permit holder will be responsible for operation, inspection,



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maintenance, and upkeep of these systems to include drain fields, any lift or live systems, tank pumping, and pipe service and maintenance.

21. Do we have any condition site reports (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area)?

A: Per the Special Use Permit language, *Appendix 10*, the Forest Service requires the concessionaire to regularly test the facilities and keep a record of the reports. The Forest Service may request copies as needed.

22. What is the status of the lift stations as it relates to GT?

A: The lift stations are operable, and have had inspections and repairs within the past two years.

23. Have there been issues with the electricity in the campgrounds? Are the electric hookups up to code?

A: There have been repairs made to the electric hookups at the campgrounds. Most issues are related to normal wear and tear. It is the responsibility of the concessionaire to keep the electric hookups up to code.

24. What happens when the day use (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area) is at capacity?

A: When the day use is at capacity, the concessionaire has a sign at the entrance indicating the springs are full.

25. What happens when the parking lot (at the Salt Springs Recreation Area) is at capacity?

A: When the parking is at capacity, the concessionaire has a sign at the entrance indicating the springs are full.

Posted (3/24/2025)

Version 1 (3/20/2025)

1. The deadline for submitting questions for the campground's solicitation is April 4, 2025, before the site visit. Interested parties may have questions regarding things observed during the site visit.

A: The Forest Service has extended the deadline for submittal of questions to April 30, 2025. Additionally, prospective applicants will have an opportunity to ask questions during the site visit. All questions and answers will be posted to Sam.gov.

2. The site visit is only two weeks prior to the application deadline. With printing and shipping times considered, this will only give applicants about one week to prepare after the site visit.



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A: The Forest Service has extended the application deadline to May 30, 2025.